

Metropolitan Planning Commission Meeting June 4th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7RppKCO_UVE
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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

Omitted: The transcript does not contain a statutory public hearing or committee session held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the meeting of the Muncie Metropolitan Planning Commission on June 26th [00:00:14](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Stephen Brand, Nate Carroll, Jerry Dishman, Teresa Hensley, Richard Ivy, Emily Kring, Owen Lachey, Jesse Landis, Ricky Sipe. (Note: The presiding officer explicitly confirmed a quorum of 8 voting members present [00:01:37](#)).
 - **Members Absent:** Not explicitly listed individually, though Adam Leech and Chris Smith were called during roll call without an immediate "here" response recorded.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Unnamed board president/chair (referred to as presiding over roll calls and procedures).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The board rose to recite the Pledge of Allegiance 00:01:03.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the May 2026 meeting were considered 00:01:45. Following a motion and second, a roll call vote recorded 6 yeses and 2 abstentions (Lachey and Landis abstained as they were not present), approving the minutes 00:02:35.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:03:54 MPC 05-26A / Resolution 2026-205: McKinley Neighborhood Overlay District Text Amendment

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rebecca Hannah, Phil Tevis, Joe Robertson, and representatives of the McKinley Live Learn Neighborhood Association.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - The application proposes an amendment to the comprehensive zoning ordinance for the City of Muncie to establish the McKinley Neighborhood Overlay District.
 - Presenters detailed the grassroots-led initiative, tracing back to the 2009 Muncie Action Plan and the 2022 master plan by Vandewalle and Associates.
 - The overlay covers six distinct areas (River Levee, Public Green Space, Education, Mixed-Use High-Density Residential, Residential Rehabilitation, and Mixed-Use High-Density Commercial/Residential).
 - It establishes design standards (front porches, gabled roofs, durable materials, walkability, street-facing requirements) and streamlines parking requirements (such as reducing required parking for developments like Walnut Commons).
 - It creates the McKinley Neighborhood Review Committee to review development proposals prior to permitting.
 - Board members and planning staff (including retired planner Fred Daniel and former planning professor Eric Kelly) discussed technical aspects, notice procedures (170 notices sent to property owners), and grandfathering provisions (existing structures are exempt unless undergoing significant changes, such as a 20% alteration to the facade, rake, or footprint).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - 00:08:00 **Phil Tevis** spoke on the history, revitalization milestones, infrastructure investments (\$9.8M by Sanitary District, \$2.8M by the city, \$21M by schools, \$40M not-for-profit/YMCA, \$38M private investment), and levee/sewer updates.
 - 00:16:30 **Joe Robertson** reviewed the master plan background, the six zones, parking code adjustments, and the development review workflow.
 - 00:27:07 **Bruce Rector** (McKinley Neighborhood Association President) spoke in support, highlighting alignment with the Vandewalle Master Plan.

- **00:30:28 Rachel Robertson** spoke in support, noting 48 petition signatures collected (39 from McKinley residents) and the desire for a community voice.
- **00:32:41 Phil Watts** (Elm Street Brewery) spoke in support, discussing the catalyst for the overlay due to unexpected commercial proposals and past neighborhood challenges.
- **00:35:35 Chad Ray** (Crew Construction) spoke in support of design standards matching neighborhood character.
- **00:36:15 Rebecca Hannah** spoke in support regarding property value protection and balanced design regulations.
- **00:38:08 Jerry D. Malone** (resident at 647 N. Jefferson) spoke in opposition/concern, asking how the overlay would affect fixed-income seniors regarding rising property taxes, and noting past infrastructure neglect.
- **00:43:08 Marla Whitaker** (801 N. Elm St.) asked questions regarding future plans for homes on Elm Street.
- **00:48:32 Eric Kelly** (urban planning expert) spoke in support, emphasizing the necessity of clear zoning rules and encouraging the commission to forward the proposal to City Council.
- Staff read numerous letters of support into the record from community stakeholders, including Muncie Community Schools (Dr. Chuck Reynolds), YMCA of Muncie (Chris Butler), Mayor Dan Ridenour, Bill and Robin Lett, Crew Construction (Jonathan Chambliss), Muncie Redevelopment Commission (Jeffrey Howe), South Central Neighborhood Association, Riverside Normal City Neighborhood Association, Destiny Christian Center (Dr. Keith O'Neal), Minnetrista Central Neighborhood Association, Muncie Land Bank (Nathaniel Howard), Old West End Neighborhood Association, Cardinal Greenway (Angie Pool), and the Whitely Community Council (Frank Scott).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with a favorable recommendation (forwarded to City Council) **by Voice Vote** (formally recorded as 8 yeses following a motion to recommend approval with an added text recommendation specifying a maximum height limit for screening and privacy fences) **01:53:45**.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(General floor comments were integrated into the public hearing / deliberation for the McKinley Overlay item above. No separate open public comment session occurred prior to adjournment.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- The presiding officer announced that the McKinley Overlay proposal will be heard by the City Council on July 6th at 6:45 PM at City Hall 01:54:12.
 - Staff reported that director reports would be deferred to the next month's meeting due to the extensive reading of letters 01:54:38.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded immediately following administrative announcements 01:54:58.
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